1. What should you do if a trailer you're towing swerves or snakes?

A. Accelerate until it stabilises itself

B. Brake hard and hold the brake on

C. Let go of the handlebars and let it correct itself

D. Ease off the throttle and reduce your speed

2. What should you be aware of when you ride a sidecar outfit for the first time?

A. You need time to get used to it

B. You'll be able to stop in a shorter distance

C. You need to accelerate around bends

D. You can approach corners without braking

3. What may you need to adjust when you're carrying a heavy load on your motorcycle?

A. The footrests

B. The gear lever

C. The seat height

D. The tyre pressure

4. What are the minimum test vehicle requirements for a motorcycle used to obtain a full category 'A' licence?

A. Solo, with a maximum power of at least 50 kW (67.1 bhp)

B. Solo, with a maximum power of at least 25 kW (33 bhp)

C. Solo, with a maximum power of at least 11 kW (14.6 bhp)

D. Fitted with a sidecar, and with a maximum power of at least 35 kW (46.6 bhp)

5. What must you do when you're carrying a load on your motorcycle's luggage rack?

A. Make sure the load is covered with plastic sheeting

B. Make sure the load is securely fastened

C. Make sure the load is unevenly balanced

D. Make sure the load is highly visible

6. What does a person need to do when they ride as a pillion passenger?

A. Have a provisional motorcycle licence

B. Give signals for the rider

C. Wear a motorcycle helmet

D. Be lighter than the rider

7. What should a pillion passenger do while they're being carried on a motorcycle?

A. Give the rider directions

B. Lean with the rider when going around bends

C. Take rear observation for the rider

D. Give arm signals for the rider

8. What should your pillion passenger do while you're riding around a bend?

A. Lean to one side to see ahead

B. Give arm signals for you

C. Check behind for other vehicles

D. Lean with you

9. What might need to be adjusted if you carry a pillion passenger?

A. Headlights

B. Fairing

C. Exhaust

D. Indicators

10. What's the speed limit on a single carriageway road for a motorcycle towing a trailer?

A. 50 mph

B. 40 mph

C. 60 mph

D. 70 mph

11. How will a heavy load in your top box affect your motorcycle?



A. It will improve stability

B. It will reduce stability

C. It will reduce tyre wear

D. It will improve braking

12. Who's responsible for making sure that a motorcycle is correctly loaded?

A. The rider of the motorcycle

B. The owner of the motorcycle

C. The licensing authority

D. The owner of the items being carried

13. What should you do before fitting a sidecar to a motorcycle?

A. Check that the motorcycle is suitable

B. Pass the extended motorcycle test

C. Have the engine tuned

D. Have the wheels balanced

14. You're using throwover saddlebags. Why is it important to make sure they're evenly loaded?

A. Uneven loads can make the battery overcharge

B. Uneven loads can make the motorcycle unstable

C. Uneven loads can make the motorcycle uncomfortable

D. Uneven loads can make the engine overheat

15. What could be affected if you fit a bulky tank bag to your motorcycle?

A. Your ability to steer

B. Your ability to accelerate

C. Your view ahead

D. Your insurance premium

16. What must you have if you want to carry a pillion passenger on your motorcycle?

A. Breakdown insurance

B. A full motorcycle licence

C. A full car licence

D. Comprehensive insurance

17. What might you need to adjust when you carry a heavy load on your motorcycle?

A. The steering-head bearings

B. The seat height

C. The rear brake

D. The tyre pressures

18. You're carrying a pillion passenger on your motorcycle. What should you do when you're following other traffic?

A. Keep further back than you normally would

B. Keep to your normal following distance

C. Get your passenger to keep checking behind

D. Get your passenger to signal for you

19. When can you carry a child as a pillion passenger?

A. When they can reach the handholds and footrests

B. When they're over 14 years old

C. When they're over 16 years old

D. When they can reach the floor from the seat

20. What should you check when you fit a sidecar to your motorcycle?

A. That the sidecar has a spare wheel

B. That the sidecar has a registration plate

C. That the sidecar is correctly aligned

D. That the sidecar has a waterproof cover

21. How will riding a motorcycle and sidecar differ from riding a solo motorcycle?

A. It will require a different riding technique

B. It will allow you to corner more quickly

C. It will allow you to brake later for hazards

D. It will improve your fuel consumption

22. You're carrying a pillion passenger on your motorcycle. What should you adjust to allow for the extra weight?

A. The balance of the rear wheel

B. The preload on the front forks

C. The preload on the rear shock absorber(s)

D. The front and rear wheel alignment

23. What's the maximum width allowed for a trailer being towed by a motorcycle?

A. 1.5 metres (4 feet 11 inches)

B. 0.5 metres (1 foot 8 inches)

C. 1 metre (3 feet 3 inches)

D. 2 metres (6 feet 6 inches)

24. What should you do when you tow a trailer with your motorcycle?

A. Make sure the trailer weighs more than the motorcycle

B. Make sure the trailer isn't more than 1 metre (3 feet 3 inches) wide

C. Make sure the trailer is fitted with brakes

D. Make sure the motorcycle also has a sidecar

25. What effect will a sidecar have when it's fitted to your motorcycle?

A. It will increase the fuel economy

B. It will reduce the motorcycle's stability

C. It will make the steering lighter

D. It will increase the stopping distance

26. How is a learner motorcyclist’s licence restricted?

A. They mustn't carry a pillion passenger

B. They mustn't ride faster than 30 mph

C. They mustn't carry panniers on their motorcycle

D. They mustn't use the right-hand lane on dual carriageways

27. When may you tow a trailer behind your motorcycle?

A. When you display a ‘long vehicle’ sign on the back of the trailer

B. When your motorcycle has shaft drive

C. When you hold a full motorcycle licence

D. When you have fitted a larger battery to your motorcycle

28. What must your motorcycle have if you're going to carry a pillion passenger?

A. A passenger seat and footrests

B. A passenger grab handle and an adjustable shock absorber

C. A passenger luggage box

D. A passenger communication system

29. What items should you carry in a motorcycle top box?

A. Heavy items

B. Lightweight items

C. Emergency items

D. Personal items

30. You hold a provisional motorcycle licence. Are you allowed to carry a pillion passenger?

A. Not at any time

B. Only if the passenger is under 21

C. Not unless you're undergoing training

D. Only if the passenger holds a full licence

31. What may be seriously affected if you overload your motorcycle?

A. The weather protection

B. The battery life

C. The handling

D. The gearbox

32. What restrictions apply if you're towing a trailer on a three-lane motorway?

A. You must not overtake

B. You must not use the right-hand lane

C. You must have a stabiliser fitted

D. You must not exceed 50 mph

Answers

1. D - Ease off the throttle and reduce your speed

Don't be tempted to use harsh braking to stop swerving or snaking, as this could make things worse. You should reduce your speed gradually by easing off the throttle.

2. A - You need time to get used to it

A motorcycle with a sidecar, or a trike, will feel very different to ride than a solo motorcycle. It requires a specific technique, especially when cornering, with different methods used for right and left turns. Keep your speed down until you get used to the outfit, especially when negotiating bends and junctions.

3. D - The tyre pressure

Carrying extra weight, such as luggage or a pillion passenger, can affect the feel and handling of your motorcycle. If possible, some items may need to be adjusted to help overcome this. These adjustments include the aim of the headlights, the suspension settings, the tyre pressures and the mirrors.

4. A - Solo, with a maximum power of at least 50 kW (67.1 bhp)

To obtain the full category 'A' on your driving licence, the motorcycle you use for your practical test must be a solo machine with a cylinder capacity of at least 595 cc and a power output of at least 50 kW (67.1 bhp).

5. B - Make sure the load is securely fastened

If you carry a load on your motorcycle you must make sure it's securely fastened. It's an offence to travel with an insecure load as it could fall into the path of following vehicles and cause danger.

6. C - Wear a motorcycle helmet

Pillion passengers must wear a correctly fastened motorcycle helmet. They must also sit astride the motorcycle, on a proper passenger seat, and use the fitted passenger footrests.

7. B - Lean with the rider when going around bends

When you ride with a pillion passenger, your motorcycle may feel unbalanced and its acceleration and braking distance may also be affected. Make sure your passenger knows they must lean with you while cornering. If they don’t, they could cause the motorcycle to become unstable and difficult to control.

8. D - Lean with you

A pillion passenger shouldn't give signals or look around for you - that's your responsibility as the rider. If your passenger has never been on a motorcycle before, make sure they know that they need to lean with you when going around bends.

9. A - Headlights

Your headlights must be properly adjusted to avoid dazzling other road users. You might need to do this when carrying a pillion passenger, because the extra weight can cause the headlight beam to aim higher than normal. You may also need to adjust the tyre pressures and the suspension.

10. A - 50 mph

When you tow a trailer, remember that you must obey the reduced speed limits of 50 mph on a single carriageway and 60 mph on a dual carriageway or motorway. Make sure that the trailer is hitched correctly and that any load in the trailer is secure. You should also bear in mind that your stopping distance may increase.

11. B - It will reduce stability

Carrying a heavy load in your top box could make your motorcycle unstable, because the weight is high up and at the very back of the machine.

12. A - The rider of the motorcycle

Correct loading is the responsibility of the rider. Overloading a motorcycle can seriously affect the control and handling. It could result in a crash, with serious or even fatal consequences.

13. A - Check that the motorcycle is suitable

If you want to fit a sidecar to your motorcycle, check that the motorcycle is suitable and can cope with the extra load. Make sure that the sidecar is securely fixed and properly aligned. If your motorcycle was registered on or after 1 August 1981, the sidecar must be fitted on the left-hand side of the motorcycle.

14. B - Uneven loads can make the motorcycle unstable

Panniers or saddlebags should be loaded so that you carry about the same weight in each bag. Uneven loading could make the motorcycle unstable, especially when cornering.

15. A - Your ability to steer

If your tank bag is too bulky, it could get in the way of your arms or restrict the movement of the handlebars.

16. B - A full motorcycle licence

Before you can carry a pillion passenger, the law requires you to have a full licence for the category of motorcycle you're using.

17. D - The tyre pressures

Take care if you're carrying a heavy load on your motorcycle. Try to carry the weight as low down as possible – ideally in panniers, with the weight evenly spread on each side. You may need to adjust your tyre pressures, your headlight aim and your rear shock-absorber preload setting.

18. A - Keep further back than you normally would

The extra weight of a passenger may increase your stopping distance. Allow for this when following another vehicle by increasing the separation distance.

19. A - When they can reach the handholds and footrests

Any passenger you carry - no matter how old they are - must be able to reach the footrests and handholds properly to remain safe on your machine. Also make sure they're wearing protective weatherproof clothing and a properly fitting helmet.

20. C - That the sidecar is correctly aligned

If the sidecar isn't correctly aligned with the mounting points, the outfit will be difficult to control and could be dangerous. Riding with a sidecar attached requires a different technique from riding a solo motorcycle. You should keep your speed down while learning this skill.

21. A - It will require a different riding technique

You'll need to adapt your riding technique when riding a motorcycle fitted with a sidecar. The extra weight will affect the handling and may increase your overall stopping distance.

22. C - The preload on the rear shock absorber(s)

When carrying a passenger or other extra weight, you may need to make adjustments, particularly to the rear shock absorber(s), tyre pressures and headlight alignment. Check your owner's handbook for details.

23. C - 1 metre (3 feet 3 inches)

When you’re towing a trailer, you must remember that you may not be able to filter through traffic. Don’t forget that the trailer is there, especially when riding round bends and negotiating junctions.

24. B - Make sure the trailer isn't more than 1 metre (3 feet 3 inches) wide

To tow a trailer behind a motorcycle, you must have a full motorcycle licence and a motorcycle with an engine larger than 125 cc. Motorcycle trailers mustn't exceed 1 metre (3 feet 3 inches) in width.

25. D - It will increase the stopping distance

A sidecar will alter the handling considerably. Give yourself time to adjust to the different characteristics and allow a greater stopping distance.

26. A - They mustn't carry a pillion passenger

Learner motorcyclists aren’t allowed to • tow a trailer • carry a pillion passenger • use the motorway. In addition, they must display red L plates (D plates in Wales) to the front and rear of the motorcycle.

27. C - When you hold a full motorcycle licence

You may not ride a motorcycle towing a trailer if you only hold a provisional motorcycle licence. When you tow a trailer, you need to be aware that lower speed limits apply and the trailer must be no more than 1 metre wide. The trailer’s laden weight should be no more than 150 kg or two-thirds of the kerbside weight of the motorcycle - whichever is less.

28. A - A passenger seat and footrests

When carrying a pillion passenger, you should explain to them that they must keep their feet on the footrests. Tell them not to give hand signals, lean away from the rider when cornering, fidget or move around. Also check that they aren’t wearing anything long or loose that could get caught in the rear wheel or drive chain.

29. B - Lightweight items

Carrying a heavy weight in a top box can cause handling problems, particularly when riding at speed. If you have heavy items to carry, it's better to carry them in panniers and keep the weight roughly the same on either side.

30. A - Not at any time

You aren't allowed to carry a pillion passenger until you hold a full motorcycle licence for the category of motorcycle that you're riding. Even when you’ve passed your test, don’t carry a passenger if you aren't confident that you can do so safely. You're responsible for their safety.

31. C - The handling

Any load will affect the handling of your motorcycle by changing its centre of gravity. When using panniers, spread the weight evenly on each side. Avoid carrying heavy items in a top box, as this could make your steering dangerously light.

32. B - You must not use the right-hand lane

The motorway regulations for towing a trailer state that you must not • use the right-hand lane of a three-lane motorway unless directed to do so (for example, at roadworks or due to a lane closure) • exceed 60 mph.